

Client Emergency Plan

3 Steps to get ready.

When it comes to extreme weather events, it's not a matter of 'if' but 'when'. Storms, floods, cyclones and bushfires can hit at any time and anywhere.



1. Step 1: Make a plan

The first step in being prepared is to have a Client emergency and evacuation plan. Complete the following emergency and evacuation plan so that everyone in the Client's support network knows exactly what to do if the worst happens.

The plan includes measures for each of the following:

- (a) preparing for, and responding to, the emergency or disaster;
- (b) making changes to participant supports;
- (c) adapting, and rapidly responding, to changes to participant supports and to other interruptions;
- (d) communicating changes to participant support to workers, participants and their support networks.

Client's family members/support network contact details			
Name		Name	
Mobile		Mobile	
Email		Email	
Name		Name	
Mobile		Mobile	
Email		Email	

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Client's that require special assistance	
Assistance required	
Aids required (if applicable)	

Pets			
Name		Name	
Type		Type	
Breed		Breed	
Vet Name		Vet Name	
Vet Number		Vet Number	
Vet Email		Vet Email	
Medications/ dosage		Medications/ dosage	

Vehicle/s make and registration			
Vehicle make		Vehicle make	
Registration		Registration	

Emergency contacts (local)		Emergency Contacts (out of town)	
Name		Name	
Phone		Phone	
Email		Email	

Local council contact details			
Name		Phone	

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Email	
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Utility companies contact details			
Type		Type	
Provider		Provider	
Phone		Phone	
Email		Email	
Type		Type	
Provider		Provider	
Phone		Phone	
Email		Email	

GP/RN/Health Practitioners contact details			
Name		Phone	
Email			

Client's Insurance company	
Type	
Name	
Phone	
Email	
Website	

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Client household safe meeting point	
Address	
Description	

Electricity supply at Client home	
Location	
How to turn off	

Gas supply Client home	
Location	
How to turn off	

Water supply Client home	
Location	
How to turn off	

Emergency and evacuation kit location	
Location	

Medications Schedule			
Medication name and strength	When does the Client take this?	How much do they take each time?	Last updated

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Checklist if required to evacuate the Client Home			
☐	Has official advice been given to evacuate?	☐	Is there an evacuation kit?
☐	Do we know where to evacuate to?	☐	Final kit check: Has all essential medications for the Client been packed?
☐	Do we know the preferred route for evacuation?	☐	Has all important documentation been packed or accessible via cloud storage?
☐	Is there a vehicle that has enough fuel to get to the evacuation point? Is it full?	☐	Final kit check: Has enough water supplies been packed?
☐	Has the power, gas and water mains been turned off at the house?	☐	Has the Client's home house been locked and secured?
☐	Are any pets safe and secure?		

2. Step 2: Pack Supplies

The second step is to pack emergency and evacuation kits. If, as a result of a natural disaster, the Worker or the client are unable to leave the Client's home for an extended period, the emergency kit should be equipped for up to three days of isolation.

2.1 Essential Emergency Kit

- (a) An Emergency kit should be kept in a sturdy waterproof storage container and stored in a safe place in your home. Make sure it is easily accessible (except young children – make it childproof if necessary). Make a note of the emergency kit's location on the Client's household emergency and evacuation plan.

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- 1 Pack 10 litres of drinking water per person at a minimum.
- 2 A properly equipped first aid kit can save lives. Make sure you include a first aid manual and include a week's supply of prescription and over the counter medication.
- 3 Include toiletries you will need for three days such as toilet paper, toothpaste, toothbrushes, soap, shampoo, personal hygiene products, sunscreen and insect repellent.
- 4 Scan and save important documents, contacts, emails and photos to a USB and keep it in your emergency kit.
- 5 Although most tins have a ring pull, there are still quite a few for which you will need a can opener.
- 6 Your emergency kit should contain up to date copies of important documents. For example documents could include your driver licence, insurance policies (home, content, vehicles, life), passports, legal documents (property deed, wills etc.), birth and marriage certificates.
- 7 Your mobile phone is key to keeping connected during a disaster. Extend the life of your phone by ensuring you have a spare phone charger packed as well as a fully charged portable battery/power pack.
- 8 Make a three day menu plan for your household and store a supply of non-perishable food in your kit.
- 9 Even if your home is not damaged in a disaster, electricity may not be available and you could be left in the dark for quite a while so include a torch (or two) or a battery powered lantern.
- 10 A pair of sturdy work gloves will help prevent injury and infection when handling rubbish and debris.
- 11 A battery powered radio is one of the most reliable items in a disaster especially during power and internet loss.
- 12 Make sure you have enough spare batteries to last three days.

2.2 Comprehensive emergency kit

- (a) For those that would like to take further steps to cover a wider range of scenarios for a longer period, additional supplies to the emergency kit can be added to ensure everything is extensively covered.

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- 13 Wrench or pliers can be used to turn off all utilities.
- 14 Your pets have their own special needs that you should prepare and plan for as a responsible pet parent. For more detail check out the **Protect what's most important to you** booklet.
- 15 In addition to basic items make sure you include a warm jumper, waterproof jacket, a hat, gloves and enclosed-toed shoes or boots for each household member.
- 16 Protect your eyes from any flying debris when cleaning up post weather event.
- 17 Rubbish bags to clean up your backyard.
- 18 Use a whistle for attracting attention if you need assistance.
- 19 A utility knife is a useful tool during and after a disaster.
- 20 For formula-fed babies check the use-by date on any formula and use it before it expires, replacing the one in your kit. Queensland Health recommends storing enough ready-to-drink formula for three days. Ready-to-use formula means you do not have to use precious supplies of water to mix with dehydrated formulas. Don't forget to include a bottle! Also include enough nappies and wipes for three days based on your baby's needs. Ensure you check sizing of nappies packed in your kit periodically as infants may outgrow the nappies you have packed for them.
- 21 Pack a small amount of cash (notes and coins) in case ATMs are inaccessible or not working due to power failure.
- 22 Include any prescribed medication and aids required by household members such as prescription glasses, medic-alert bracelet or necklace (keep a spare in your kit), dosage measures (syringes, measuring cups), epipen or batteries for hearing aids.
- 23 A tarpaulin and ropes can be used to cover any areas of your home that may have been damaged during severe weather. These should only be affixed once the weather system has passed and it is safe to do so.
- 24 Blankets will keep you warm if you are exposed to the elements.
- 25 Beds can become damaged or sodden during a weather event such as a cyclone, severe storm or flood. Camping mattresses and sleeping bags are easy to store with your kit.
- 26 Think about including cooking equipment, the items you need to serve it up, eat it and store it.
- 27 If you are without power think about how you are going to cook or heat up meals.

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2.3 Evacuation kit

- (a) There may be times during an emergency where it becomes unsafe for the Client to stay at home and may need to evacuate. In addition to the emergency kit, an evacuation kit needs to be prepared. The evacuation kit is designed to contain only essential items that can easily and quickly ‘grab and go’.



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- 1** A properly equipped first aid kit can save lives. Make sure you include a first aid manual and include a week's supply of prescription and over the counter medication. Make sure it is all within its use-by date.
- 2** Your evacuation kit should contain up to date copies of the same important documents in your emergency kit.
- 3** A pair of sturdy work gloves will help prevent injury and infection when needing to handle rubbish and debris.
- 4** Include any aids required by household members such as prescription glasses, medic-alert bracelet or necklace (keep a spare in your kit), dosage measures (syringes, measuring cups), epipen or batteries for hearing aids.
- 5** Electricity may not be available where you are headed to and you could be left in the dark for quite a while so include a torch (or two) or a battery powered lantern.
- 6** Add toiletries you will need for three days such as toilet paper, toothpaste, toothbrush, soap, shampoo, personal hygiene products, sunscreen and insect repellent.
- 7** Mobile phones are key to keeping everyone connected during a disaster. Extend the life of your phone by ensuring you have your phone's power cord packed as well as a fully charged portable battery/power pack.
- 8** Multiple changes of clothes for each household member (long pants, long-sleeved shirts, hats and strong shoes are recommended).
- 9** Pillow and sleeping bag for each household member.
- 10** Pack some books and games that do not require electricity to entertain younger household members.
- 11** For formula-fed babies check the use-by date on any formula and use it before it expires, replacing the one in your kit. Queensland Health recommends storing enough ready-to-drink formula for three days. Ready-to-use formula means you do not have to use precious supplies of water to mix with dehydrated formulas. Don't forget to include a bottle! Also include enough nappies and wipes for three days based on your baby's needs. Ensure you check sizing of nappies packed in your kit periodically as infants may outgrow the nappies you have packed for them.
- 12** Pack a small amount of cash (notes and coins) in case ATMs are inaccessible or not working due to power failure.
- 13** Place a reminder on your evacuation checklist to grab valuables, photos (prints, CDs, USB data stick) and small mementos – make a list as it may be hard to think clearly at the time of evacuation.
- 14** Pack drinking water.
- 15** A battery powered radio is one of the most reliable items in a disaster especially during power and internet loss.
- 16** Although most tins have a ring pull, there are still quite a few for which you will need a can opener.
- 17** Make sure you have enough spare batteries to last three days. Ensure you have packed the correct battery type and quantities required for your torch, radio, kid's toys that are packed and other included electricals.
- 18** Non-perishable snacks like muesli bars and packet snacks will curb hunger until you reach your evacuation point.

3. Step 3: Make sure the Client's covered

The third step is to make sure the Client's home and contents insurance cover is up to date. Client's who are both renters and homeowners should be covered for disasters and should be familiar with their coverage details.

3.1 Workers should check with their Client to see what their policy covers in the event of an emergency.

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1 What disasters does the policy cover?



2 How do they define each disaster?



3 How much will the policy cover?



4 Does the policy provide enough insurance to cover the cost of rebuilding your house and any extra costs you might incur?



5 Is your insurance adequate to cover the replacement of your possessions?



6 Are your possessions covered for damage caused by potential local hazards such as storm, cyclone, flood and bushfire?



7 In what circumstances will the insurer reject the claim?



8 Are you covered for the cost of temporary accommodation if your home is uninhabitable?



9 Does pre-existing damage caused by a previous natural disaster or lack of home maintenance impact eligibility of insurance claim payouts?

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4. Fire Emergency

- (a) you and your support network should do what is reasonably practicable to ensure that fire equipment is installed in each residence or building where it works which is suitable for risks specific to the relevant residence or building.
 - (b) Fire equipment will be placed away from heat sources and regularly maintained.
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5. Floods

In preparation for a flood, you and your support network should:

- (a) obtain a copy of the local council's flood plan, which should show the location of problem areas, evacuation routes and relief centres.
 - (b) work out what the safest route to leave each of the residences and buildings where it works would be, and if the route could be cut off by floodwaters.
 - (c) ensure arrangements are made to obtain sandbags to protect the residences and buildings where it works.
 - (d) know the kind of flooding the general area is prone to.
 - (e) If a flood is likely, tune in to the local ABC Radio station and keep listening for advice and warnings.
 - (f) identify the safest route to the nearest relief centre and leave well before roads are closed by water.
 - (g) get ready to move vehicles, outdoor equipment, garbage, chemicals and poisons to higher locations.
 - (h) work out which indoor items you want to put in a higher spot.
 - (i) ensure you have prepared an Emergency Kit,
 - (j) raise furniture, clothing and other valuables onto beds, tables and into roof spaces.
 - (k) empty freezers and refrigerators, leaving doors open.
 - (l) turn off power, water and gas.
 - (m) lock the residence or building and take the safest evacuation route out of the area.
 - (n) not drive through floodwater.
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6. Storms

In preparation for a storm, you and your support network should:

- (a) Check fences, roofs and gutters; make any repairs that are needed.
- (b) Trim branches near power lines.
- (c) Clean gutters and downpipes regularly; also secure loose roof tiles/sheets.
- (d) Move cars undercover and away from trees.

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- (e) Put away or secure loose items like outdoor furniture and pot plants.
- (f) Disconnect all electrical items.
- (g) stay tuned to your local ABC Radio station, listen online or via the ABC listen app, and/or check ABC Emergency Twitter and Facebook for updates, warnings and advice.
- (h) While conditions are severe, stay indoors and keep away from windows.
- (i) Check on and assist Clients to see if they are safe and prepared.
- (j) Assist Clients to evacuate.
- (k) Don't drive into flood water.
- (l) Stay clear of creeks, drains and other waterways as there is a risk of flooding, including flash floods.
- (m) Be careful of fallen trees, powerlines and damaged buildings.

7. COVID-19

7.1 General

- (a) You and your support network should comply with the state government's advice.
- (b) You should follow these simple steps to help stop the spread of germs:
 - (1) You should wash your hands often with soap and running water or use an alcohol-based hand rub.
 - (2) Make sure there are enough tissues and bins available.
 - (3) Keep a distance of at least 1.5 metres from others where possible.
 - (4) Clean often during the day, paying particular attention to frequently touched surfaces in common areas.
 - (5) Limit visitors as much as possible.
 - (6) Anyone who has COVID-19 symptoms should be isolated into a single room straight away. Arrange a medical review as soon as possible.

7.2 Personal Protective Equipment

Where possible you should wear a surgical mask.

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8. General

8.1 Relevant Legislation, Regulations, Rules and Guidelines

Legislation, Rules, Guidelines and Policies apply to this Policy and Related Documentation as set out in the Legislation Register.

8.2 Inconsistency

If and to the extent that the terms of this Policy are or would be inconsistent with the requirements of any applicable law, this Policy is deemed to be amended but only to the extent required to comply with the applicable law.

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